

Music

WACE Examination—2010 design brief

Stage 3

The Music examination comprises a written examination worth 50% of the total examination score and a practical/portfolio component worth 50% of the total examination score.

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes

Working time for paper: two hours and thirty minutes

Permissible items

Standard items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, ruler, highlighter

Special items: nil

Additional information

The written paper addresses Outcomes 3 and 4. The questions in Section Two and Section Three enable candidates to respond with specific reference to their context. Knowledge and understanding of conventional western notation is examined in the written component.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Aural and Analysis Common Section 4–8 questions with subparts 30% of the written exam 30 marks Suggested working time: 40 minutes	Section One contains compulsory perception questions. Questions focus on musical excerpts that apply to all four contexts and are based on the elements of music drawn from the common core content. Questions are drawn from the following: harmonic progression dictations; interval recognition; rhythmic dictations; pitch dictations (rhythms provided); melodic dictations (rhythm and pitch required); recognition of tonality; skeleton score; listening identification and response questions; general questions regarding the elements of music. Melodic dictation examples are performed using the piano. Answers can be typically given as notated responses using western staff notation and short answer.
Section Two Music skills Context specific questions from: Western Art Music Jazz Contemporary Music World and Indigenous Musics 4–7 questions with subparts 40% of the written exam 40 marks Suggested working time: 60 minutes	Section Two contains perception questions that are based on the elements of music such as rhythmic, melodic and harmonic dictations, intervals, skeleton scores, tonality identification and general questions regarding the elements of music specific to the content of the context studied. Answers can typically be given as notated responses, short answers or multiple-choice answers. Questions may require candidates to give aural comparison and contrast of musical excerpts that are similar to the suggested works list. Candidates may be asked to analyse a previously unfamiliar musical work similar to those of the suggested works list. This may include a short response to a musical excerpt with reference to a score and/or analysis, orchestration and theory tasks based on an unfamiliar score. In the contexts of Western Art Music and World and Indigenous Musics, context specific theory questions are in formats such as transposition, transcriptions, orchestration, short arrangements, SATB harmonisation, analysing chord progressions and cadences. In the context of Jazz, theory questions are in formats such as orchestration, transposition, transcriptions, short arrangements and analysing chord progressions. In the context of Contemporary Music, questions are based on notation of a rhythm section accompaniment chart (guitar, bass, drum kit) from a musical excerpt which is 8 to 12 bars long. Questions are based on a song/lead sheet, identifying form/structure, texture, timbre and instrumental/vocal expressive techniques.

Section	Supporting information
Section Three Cultural and Historical Perspectives Context specific Part A: Short answer Two questions with subparts Part B: Extended answer One question from a choice of three 30% of the written exam 30 marks Suggested working time: 50minutes	This section is divided into two parts. Questions here are based on context specific musical works. Part A: Each subpart of the question requires an answer of no more than three lines in length. Each question has a weighting of 10%. Part B: Candidates answer one question from a choice of three. Candidates are to write extended answers of between one to one and a half pages in length. The question has a weighting of 10%.